

UI/UX Design Analysis

Coffee Meets Bagel & Drops Language Learning

Screen-by-Screen Breakdown · April 2026

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1. Overview & Design Philosophy

Coffee Meets Bagel (CMB) is a dating app founded in 2012. Its UI/UX is built around a single thesis: quality over quantity. Every screen — the daily match limit, rich profile format, chat expiry timer — reinforces this philosophy.

Core UX Principles

Intentionality	Limited, curated profiles daily — never an endless feed
Text-first	Bios and Q&A prompts take visual precedence over photos
Anti-ghosting	Chat expiry timers push both parties to actually converse
Warm tone	Coffee/café metaphors make the experience feel casual
Soft monetisation	Beans currency gives spending agency without hard paywalls
Social proof	Mutual Facebook connections shown to build trust

2. Onboarding & Login Screen

Login Methods

Facebook	Primary auth — enables mutual-friends feature; one-tap sign-in
Phone / SMS	6-digit OTP code; auto-read on iOS and Android
Email	Email + password fallback option
Apple Sign In	iOS only; privacy-preserving masked email option

Onboarding Steps

Step 1: Auth method selection — large, thumb-friendly buttons

Step 2: Basic info: name, birthdate, gender, orientation

Step 3: Photos: 2–6 uploads, drag-to-reorder, primary photo crops to square

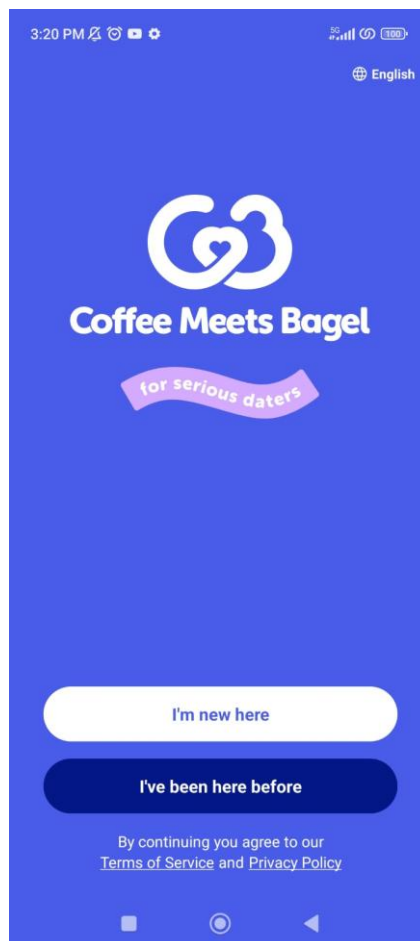
Step 4: Prompts: choose 3 from 20+ icebreaker questions, 150-char answers

Step 5: Preferences: gender, age range, max distance sliders

Step 6: Attributes: height, religion, ethnicity chips — all optional

Step 7: Push notification permission — framed as 'never miss a Bagel'

Step 8: Location permission — friendly copy explaining the why



3. Discover — Daily Bagels

The Discover screen replaces the infinite swipe deck with a curated queue of up to 21 profiles per day — each called a 'Bagel'.

Screen Anatomy

Photo card	Full-bleed image, 16:9 ratio; pinch to zoom; name/age/distance overlaid at bottom
Headline prompt	One-line ice-breaker answer shown below photo
Like / Pass CTAs	Large coral 'Like' (heart) and gray 'Pass' (X) — side by side, thumb-reach height
Bagel counter	'X Bagels left today' — reinforces daily scarcity
Empty state	Countdown timer to next day's queue when all Bagels are used

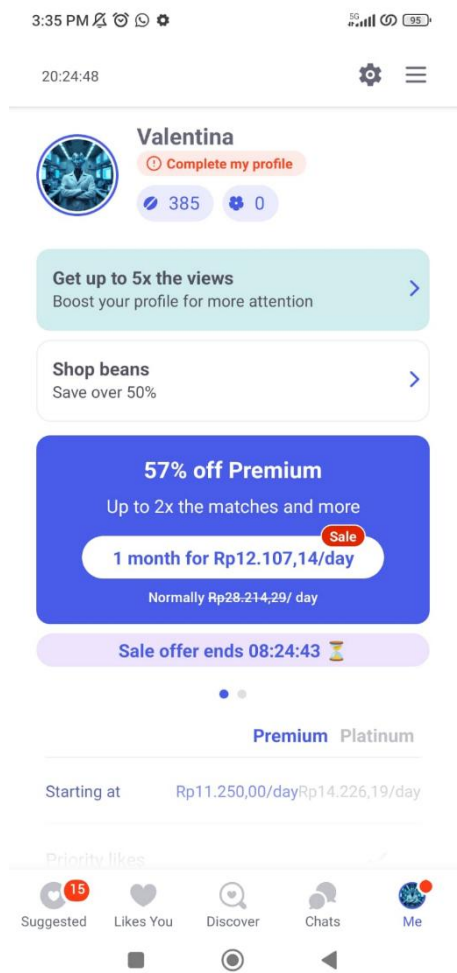


4. Profile Detail View

Tapped from the Discover card — the richest screen in the app. Designed to be read, not skimmed.

Screen Sections (top to bottom)

Photo carousel	Multi-photo strip; tap to advance; dot indicator; no auto-play
Name block	First name, age, distance, verified badge
Bio	Up to 500 characters, displayed in full — no truncation
Prompt cards	3 Q&A cards — question in gray italic, answer in primary black
Attribute chips	Height · Religion · Politics · Drinking · Smoking
Mutual friends	Small avatar row if Facebook-linked
Sticky action bar	Fixed 'Like' and 'Pass' bar persists while scrolling the profile



5. Likes You

Free tier	3-column grid with blurred/mosaic faces — count visible, identities hidden
Premium tier	Fully unblurred grid; tap to view full profile and act
Sort order	Most recent likes first — freshness creates urgency
Upgrade hook	Soft inline CTA banner above the blurred grid — no intrusive modal

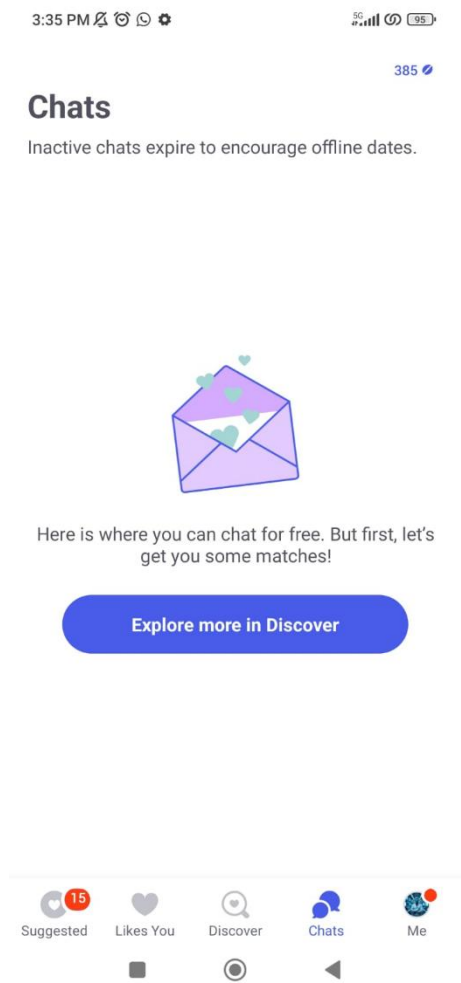
6. Matches & Chat

Inbox (Match List)

Row layout	Avatar + name + last message preview + timestamp
Expiry chip	Countdown shown on each match — turns red under 24 hours
Unread badge	Red dot on avatar for unread messages
New match chip	Coral 'New match!' tag until first message is sent

Chat Thread

Expiry bar	Slim countdown progress bar directly below the header
Message bubbles	Sender = coral right-aligned; receiver = gray left-aligned
Icebreaker tray	Horizontal scroll of suggested openers from partner's prompts
Composer	Text input + emoji picker + GIF search (Tenor); no voice messages



7. Beans — In-App Currency

Earn (Free)

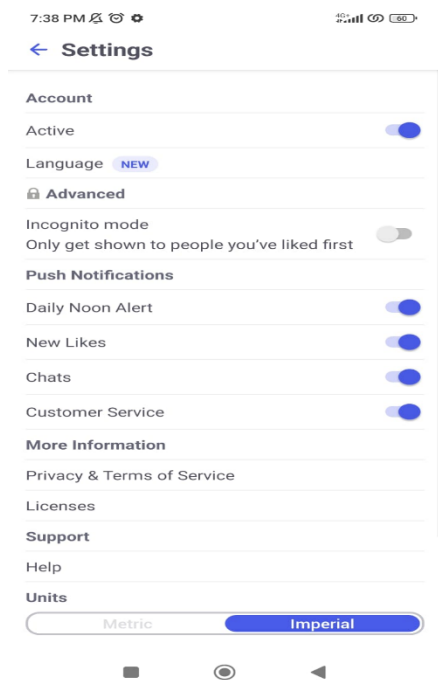
Daily login	+1 Bean per day
Profile complete	+10–50 Beans per section filled
Invite friends	+20 Beans per successful referral

Spend

Extend a match	50 Beans — adds 24h to an expiring chat
Woo	150 Beans — highlighted Like with a personal note
Streak repair	30 Beans — re-earn Activity Badge

8. Profile & Settings

Photo manager	Drag-to-reorder grid; tap to replace; star marks primary photo
Bio editor	Tappable text area with 500-char counter; auto-saves on exit
Prompts editor	Tap any prompt to change question or edit answer
Preview button	Shows exact view that Bagels would see before going live
Discovery prefs	Gender, age range slider, distance slider
Notifications	Granular toggles per event type
Snooze mode	Temporarily hides profile without deleting — high-retention feature



9. Navigation & Visual Design

Bottom Navigation (4 tabs)

Discover	Coffee cup icon — daily Bagels queue; badge shows remaining count
Liked You	Heart icon — who liked your profile; badge shows unseen count
Matches	Chat bubble icon — inbox; badge shows unread count
Profile	Person icon — your profile + all settings

Color & Typography

Primary brand	#B84C2E — warm coral/rust; CTAs, active nav, accents
Background	Off-white — warmer than pure white, less clinical feel
Font	Circular (SF Pro / Roboto fallback) — rounded, friendly
Heading	24–28px bold; Body 15–16px; Labels 12–13px
Motion	Horizontal slide transitions; confetti on match; no parallax or physics

10. CMB vs Competitors

Key UI/UX dimensions compared against the three most similar dating apps.

Feature	Coffee Meets Bagel	Tinder	Hinge	Bumble
Daily limit	21 Bagels	Unlimited	~8 (free)	Unlimited
Interaction	Tap Like / Pass	Swipe L/R	Like / X	Swipe L/R
Chat expiry	8 days	None	None	24h (women)
Profile depth	High (prompts)	Low (photos)	Very high	High
In-app currency	Beans	Gold/Platinum	Roses	Coins
Free gate	Blurred Likes	No rewind	Full Likes	No SuperSwipe

Key Differentiators

- Only major dating app with a hard daily profile cap (21 Bagels)
- 8-day chat expiry is unique among the four compared apps
- Profile depth (bio + 3 prompts + attribute chips) matches Hinge and exceeds Tinder and Bumble
- Beans is the most nuanced soft-currency system — more earn opportunities, more granular spend

11. Overview & Design Philosophy

Drops is a language learning app covering 55+ languages, built around one constraint: 5 minutes per day. Every design decision — visual vocabulary games, drag-and-match mechanics, streak system — is engineered to make learning feel fast, fun, and habit-forming.

Core UX Principles

5-min session cap	Free users get exactly 5 minutes — creates urgency and daily habit
Visual-first learning	Every word is paired with a custom illustration, not text translation
Game mechanics	Drag-and-match games replace traditional flashcard repetition
Spaced repetition	Words reappear based on memory science — harder for forgotten words
Micro-commitment	Short sessions lower the barrier to 'just one more' return visit
Illustration system	3,000+ custom-illustrated vocabulary words — consistent, inclusive style

12. Onboarding & Login

Login Methods

Google	One-tap OAuth — primary on Android
Apple Sign In	Primary on iOS; privacy-preserving
Facebook	Available but less prominent
Email	Traditional email + password; least prominent
Guest mode	Full lesson without account — sign-up prompted after completion

Onboarding Steps

Step 1: Language selection — grid of 55+ illustrated flag cards; searchable

Step 2: Reason for learning — Travel, Culture, Career, Brain Training, etc.

Step 3: Experience level — Beginner / Some words / Conversational

Step 4: Topic interests — multi-select chip grid (Food, Travel, People...)

Step 5: Daily goal — 5 / 10 / 15 min options

Step 6: Notification permission — framed as streak protection

Step 7: Tutorial lesson — full 5-min guided lesson before account creation

Step 8: Account creation — 'Save your progress' framing post-lesson.

13. Home / Dashboard Screen

The Home screen balances session entry (primary action), progress visibility, and content discovery without overwhelming the user.

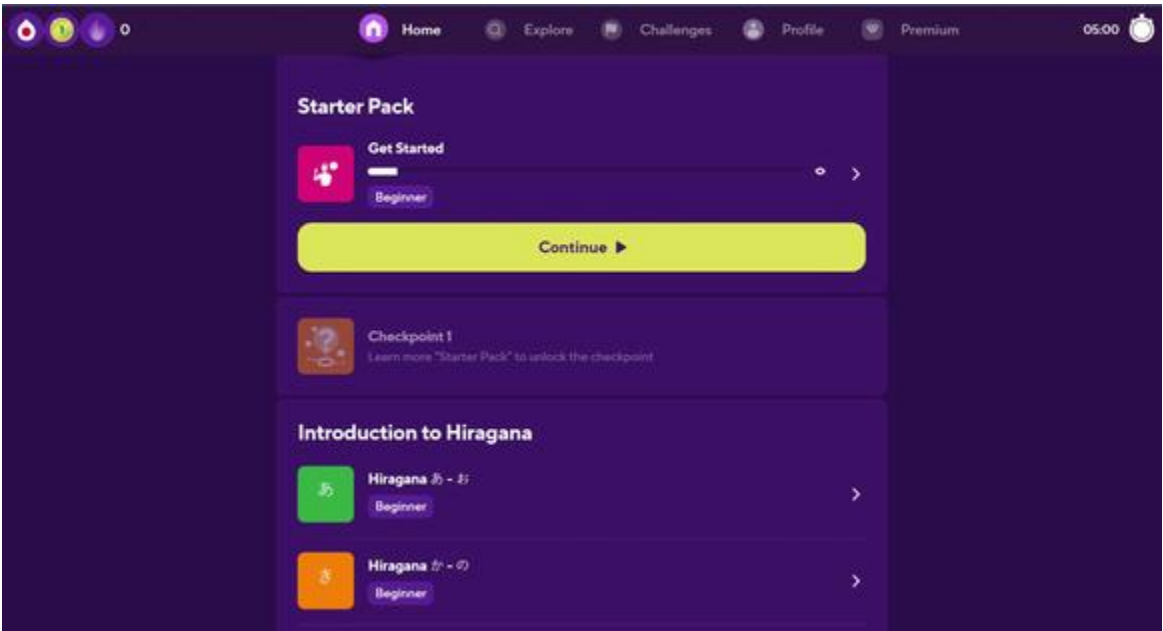


Fig 1. Drops Home Screen — Starter Pack, topic navigation, and session entry

Screen Anatomy

5:00 timer	Top-right countdown clock — shows exactly how much free time remains
Starter Pack	Featured lesson pack with progress bar — primary learning path
Continue CTA	Large yellow 'Continue' button — single unmissable primary action
Checkpoint	Locked milestone card — motivates completing the current pack
Script sections	Hiragana/Katakana topic rows — color-coded cards with native characters
Top nav	Home · Explore · Challenges · Profile · Premium — 5-tab horizontal nav

UX Note: The session timer is the most important element — it frames learning as a finite ritual. Seeing '5:00' remaining before it begins makes the session feel manageable, not daunting.

14. Explore Screen

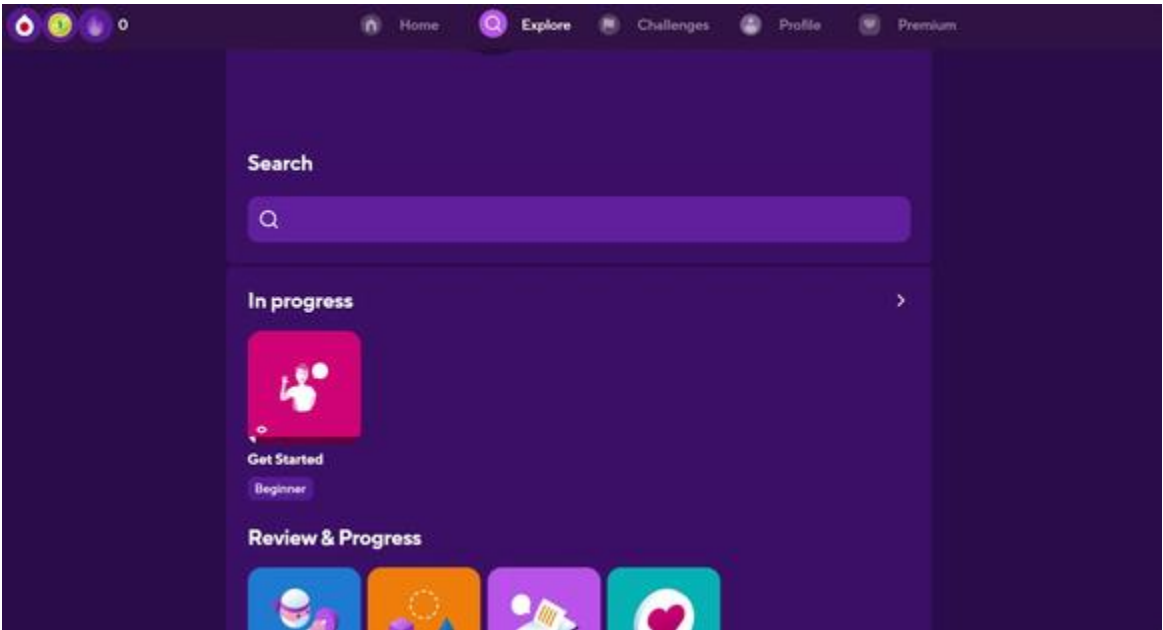


Fig 2. Explore Screen — Search, In Progress packs, and Review & Progress tools

Search bar	Full-width search field — find any word pack or topic by name
In progress	Cards for currently active learning packs — quick resume access
Review & Progress	Grid of review mode cards: flashcard review, accuracy test, conversation mode, favorites
Card design	Each pack shown as a colored rounded square with illustration + title + level badge

15. Challenges Screen

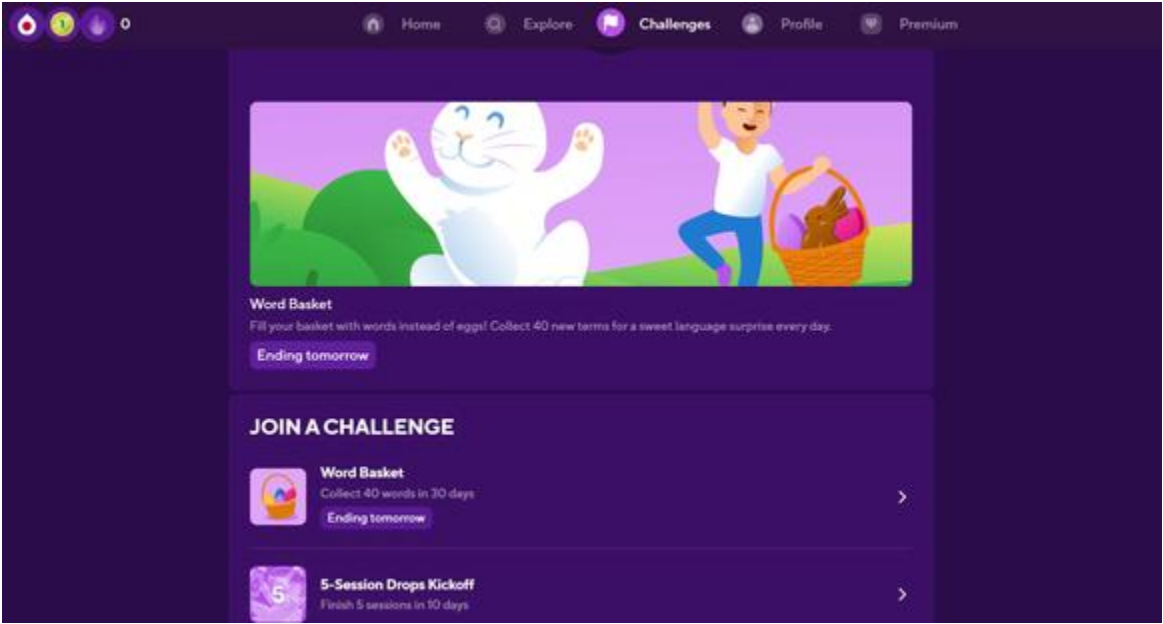


Fig 3. Challenges Screen — Seasonal challenge hero and joinable challenge list

Hero banner	Full-width seasonal illustration with challenge name and description
Urgency tag	'Ending tomorrow' chip — FOMO mechanic identical in spirit to CMB's expiry timer
Challenge list	Scrollable list of joinable challenges — icon + name + goal + deadline
Challenge types	Word count goals (collect 40 words), session goals (5 sessions in 10 days)
Illustration style	Custom seasonal artwork — Easter, New Year, etc. — maintains brand warmth

16. Lesson & Game Screens

Drops' flagship UX — the game-based learning engine that defines the app's identity. Two lesson screens are shown below, captured during active sessions.



Fig 4. Orange lesson screen — vocabulary introduction with illustration + romanization

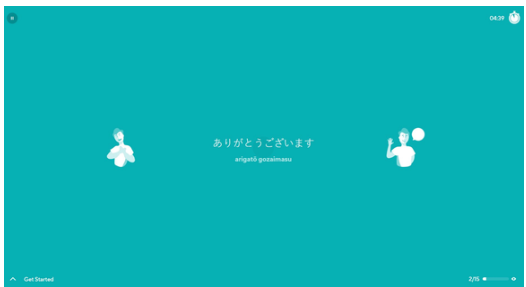


Fig 5. Teal lesson screen — drag-to-match game with two character choices

What These Screenshots Show

Full-bleed color	Each game type uses a distinct background color — orange for intro, teal for matching
Word illustration	Custom character illustration centered — visual-to-word association core mechanic
Target script	Word displayed in target script (ありがとうございます) — large, legible, center-screen
Romanization	Romaji shown below — 'arigatō gozaimasu' — toggleable via Transcription Aid switch
Script toggle	Top-left: Kana / Kanji+Kana toggle — adapts display to learner level
Swipe mechanic	Left arrow (checkmark = already knew it) / Right arrow (speaker = hear pronunciation)
Session counter	Bottom-right '2/15' progress indicator — shows position in current word set
Timer	Top-right countdown '04:52' — consistent across all game screens
Pause button	Top-left pause icon — accessible at any point in a session

All Game Types

- Drag to match — drag a word to its matching illustration
- Drag to image — reverse; drag an illustration to its word
- Word drop — tap correct falling letters to spell the word
- Swipe to sort — swipe cards left/right based on recognition
- Quiz mode — 4-option multiple choice from a shown illustration
- Grammar tips — short contextual grammar tip cards (new feature: EN/ES/DE/PT)

17. Profile & Progress



Fig 6. Profile Screen — avatar, language badges, Total XP counter, and Streak tracking

Avatar	Large circular avatar with initial — pink/magenta on dark purple background
Language badges	Drops icon + flag icon showing currently active learning languages
Total XP	Running XP total with gold XP badge — tangible progress metric
Streak counter	Flame icon + current streak count below — always visible on profile
Stats sections	Scrollable stat rows: words learned, sessions completed, accuracy rate
Settings gear	Top-right gear icon — account settings, notification prefs, subscription

18. Premium & Monetisation

Free limit	5 minutes per session — timer ends the lesson; one language; ads between sessions
Unlimited	No session time limit; multiple languages; offline mode; no ads
Streak shield	Premium-only — one weekly shield prevents streak loss on missed days
Paywall trigger	Shown at end of 5-min session — 'Continue learning' CTA at peak motivation
Paywall design	Full-screen feature checklist + pricing tiers; annual plan highlighted as 'best value'
Free trial	Offered on first paywall view — lowers conversion barrier significantly
Gems	Secondary soft currency for streak repair and minor boosts — IAP packs

UX Note: *The 5-minute cap is a freemium masterclass — long enough to deliver genuine value and build habit, short enough to leave users wanting more. The paywall appears exactly when motivation is highest: right after a satisfying lesson.*

19. Navigation & Visual Design

Top Navigation (5 tabs — Web version)

Home	Raindrop icon — main lesson dashboard and Starter Pack
Explore	Search icon — browse all word packs by topic; review tools
Challenges	Flag icon — seasonal and ongoing challenges
Profile	Person icon — XP, streaks, stats, account settings
Premium	Diamond icon — upgrade prompt; visible to free users always

Color System

Background	Deep purple (#2C1D5B) — dark, immersive; makes illustrations pop
Primary action	Yellow-green (#C8E832) — high-contrast CTA; 'Continue' button
Lesson: orange	Full-bleed orange (#F5821F) — vocabulary introduction screens
Lesson: teal	Full-bleed teal (#3CBFB4) — drag-to-match game screens
Accent: magenta	Profile avatar, badge chips, active elements
Text	White and light purple on dark backgrounds throughout

Typography & Illustration

- Primary font: rounded sans-serif — friendly, highly legible at small sizes
- Heading: 22–28px medium; Body: 15–16px regular; Labels: 12px
- 3,000+ custom illustrated vocabulary words — warm, inclusive, professional style
- Full-bleed colored lesson backgrounds — each game type has a distinct hue
- Micro-animations: correct answer scale-up, incorrect shake, streak milestone confetti

20. Drops vs Competitors

Key UI/UX dimensions compared against the three most similar language learning apps.

Feature	Drops	Duolingo	Babbel	Memrise
Focus	Visual vocabulary	Gamified grammar	Structured courses	Vocab + native video
Lesson length	5 min daily	5–20 min	15–30 min	3–5 min
Languages	55+	40+	14	~22
Game mechanics	Drag & match	XP + leagues	Linear paths	Mnemonics
Free tier	5 min/day cap	Full (with ads)	First lesson only	Partial
Visual design	Illustrated, vibrant	Flat cartoon	Clean, corporate	Dark, native-video

Key Differentiators

- Only major language app with a hard daily time gate on the free tier (5 minutes)
- Custom illustration library (3,000+ words) is a visual moat no competitor matches
- 55+ languages is the broadest coverage — 40%+ more than Babbel
- Guest-first onboarding (value before account) is rare among edtech apps — and highly effective
- Full-bleed colored lesson canvases make each game type instantly identifiable — no UI chrome needed